

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

This lesson discusses the unique challenges posed by the rook's pawn. The rook's pawn is the most difficult to promote due to the risk of stalemate when it reaches the 7th rank. The position requires careful maneuvering to ensure the pawn's path is clear, and the lesson emphasizes the importance of the defending king's position in relation to the pawn.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White's goal is to promote the rook's pawn while avoiding stalemate, while Black aims to block the pawn's path and create a fortress.

STRATEGY

Ensure the rook's pawn has a clear path to promotion by positioning the king effectively. The lesson emphasizes the importance of the defending king's position in relation to the pawn and avoiding stalemate situations.

MOVES

First, move your king to h1 to avoid stalemate. If the black king moves to h2, you can advance the pawn. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Kh1 Kf3 2. Kg1 Kf4 3. Kg2 1-0

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson highlights the unique challenges posed by the rook's pawn and the importance of avoiding stalemate situations. It also emphasizes the need for careful maneuvering to ensure the pawn's path is clear.